



Marva Abouei

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marva.abouei@gmail.com ↗

About me

Product designer with a master's in Human-Computer Interaction and 6+ years of experience designing human-centred, intuitive, accessible digital solutions that drive user delight and growth. Skilled in UX/UI and service design with a research-driven approach, strong usability focus, and proven cross-functional collaboration. Currently leading product design at ISM Creative, Vancouver, Canada.

Education

Master of Human-Computer Interaction

Uppsala University, Sweden

Sep 2019 - Jun 2021

User Experience Design Certificate

Emily Carr University Art + Design

Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

Experience

Lead Product Designer

Sep 2024 - Present

ISM Creative · Remote

Lead 0-to-1 product design for early-stage startups across SaaS, web, mobile, and XR, turning ambiguous business ideas and complex requirements into validated, buildable product experiences. Partner with founders, product stakeholders, engineers, and domain experts to shape product strategy, define MVP scope, establish UX/UI direction, and guide design through delivery in lean, fast-paced teams.

Selected project

AI-Driven Psychoeducational Assessment

SaaS

B2B2C

MVP Development

- Led end-to-end product design to support psychologists, special education professionals, and parents in identifying potential learning differences and generating personalised learning plans.
- Designed human-in-the-loop workflows and interfaces where clinical NLP analysis and AI insights support professional judgement, ensuring clinicians retain transparency and control during high-stakes evaluations.
- Partnered with the product manager, engineers, and clinical advisors to define personas, map user journeys, and translate complex assessment workflows into clear, intuitive interaction models.
- Conducted user research, usability testing, and heuristic evaluations, translating findings into iterative improvements to reduce cognitive load and improve workflow completion.
- Established UX principles for responsible AI, incorporating transparency, explainability, privacy considerations, and user controls into the MVP experience.
- Used rapid prototyping and iterative design to support development sprints, stakeholder demonstrations, and early validation with prospective B2B clients.

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+1 (604) 719 7573 [↗](#)

Skills

Human-centred design, user and market research, competitive analysis, persona, journey mapping, user stories, systems thinking, product strategy, roadmapping, UX metrics and KPIs

Concept maps, service blueprinting, information architecture, responsive design, web accessibility (WCAG 2.2)

Ideation, user flow diagram, wireframing, iterative prototyping, style guides, design systems management

Heuristic evaluation, A/B testing, usability testing, project management, agile methodology, risk and dependency management

Tools

Figma, Claude, Photoshop, Miro, Jira, Notion, Google Analytics, Google Workspace, GitHub, UserTesting, Hotjar, Optimal Workshop, ChatGPT, FlutterFlow, AppSheet, Webflow, WordPress, Framer, EditorX, HTML & CSS

Certificates

- UX Design Practices for AI
- Usable Security
- UX Research for Agile Teams
- Designing with WCAG 2.2
- Conducting Usability Testing

Experience, continued

UX/UI Designer May 2022 - Aug 2024

ISM Creative · Remote

- Owned end-to-end UX/UI design across web, desktop, mobile, and immersive products, from early concept through shipped experience.
- Diagnosed usability barriers for first-time VR users and redesigned core interactions, raising SUS from 49 to 86 and strengthening the product story in early-stage funding conversations.
- Identified navigation and IA gaps through research and analytics, then drove a redesign that contributed to approximately 37% growth in traffic and 19% growth in conversions.
- Partnered with engineering to improve performance and navigation, contributing to approximately 40% faster load times and 60% greater navigation efficiency.

UX/UI Designer Nov 2020 - May 2022

Harmony Group · Remote

- Redesigned an e-commerce site's information architecture (IA), resolving friction across key user journeys.
- Validated navigation and IA decisions through card sorting and usability testing before rollout.
- Contributed to a ~45% increase in task success, ~10% growth in conversions, and ~15% reduction in bounce rate within three months of launch.

Mentorship

Startup Mentor Aug 2026 - Present

BIPOC Foundation · Remote

- Selected as a product and design mentor for founders in the BIPOC Founders Hub Accelerator.
- Mentor early-stage founders on product strategy, discovery, customer validation, MVP definition, and product-market fit.
 - Advise on AI product experiences, user workflows, feature prioritisation, and aligning user needs with technical feasibility and business goals.